

Fretboard Atlas

Every note, five pentatonic shapes, and the CAGED map

The neck on paper: a full note chart to the 12th fret, the five minor pentatonic shapes in A, the five CAGED shapes of a C major chord, and a two-week plan to make them stick.

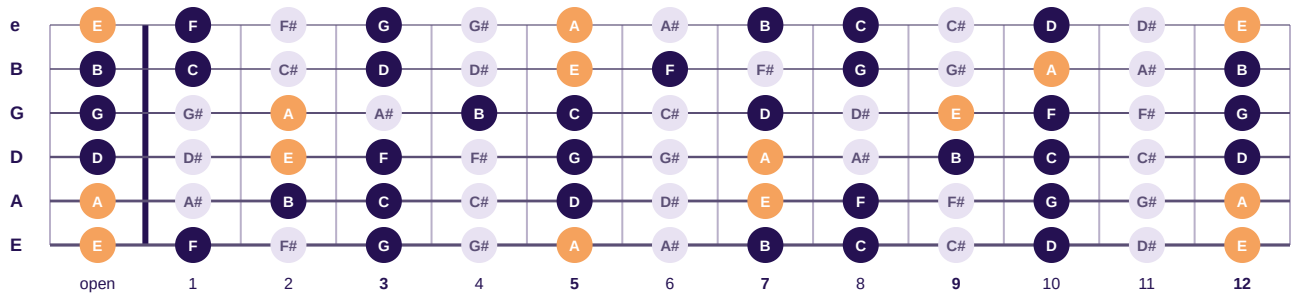
INSIDE

1. Every note, frets 0 to 12
2. Landmarks that make it easy
3. Five minor pentatonic shapes
4. Five CAGED shapes
5. A two-week memorization plan

Free from guitarhub.org. Share it, print it, pin it above the amp. The interactive versions of these ideas live at guitarhub.org/tone.

NOTES

Every note on the neck



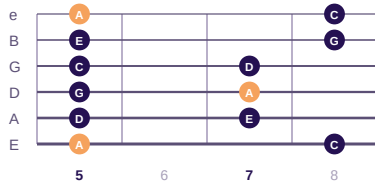
Standard tuning. Dark dots are natural notes; light dots are sharps (also called flats: C# is D $\flat$). E and A are highlighted as landmarks.

Landmarks that make it easy

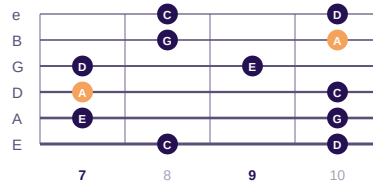
- The 12th fret repeats the open strings an octave up. Learn frets 0 to 11 and you know the whole neck.
- The low and high E strings have the same notes.
- There is no sharp between B and C or between E and F.
- Octave shape: from the low E or A string, go two strings up and two frets up.
- From the D or G string, go two strings up and three frets up (the B string shifts it).
- Fret 5 on each string matches the next open string, except the G string, where it is fret 4.

Five minor pentatonic shapes (A minor)

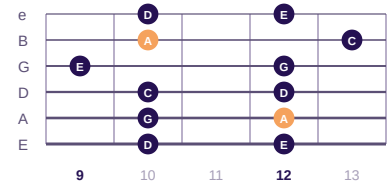
A minor pentatonic is A, C, D, E, G. The same five notes, in five overlapping boxes up the neck. Orange dots are the root, A.



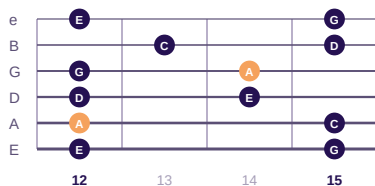
Shape 1



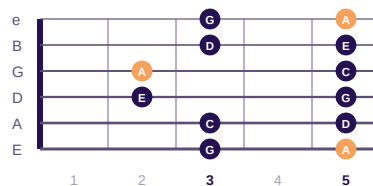
Shape 2



Shape 3



Shape 4



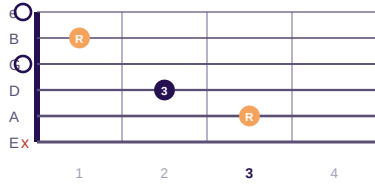
Shape 5 (also at frets 15 to 17)

Move the key by sliding every shape. Shape 1 starts on the root on the low E string: at fret 5 it is A minor, at fret 3 G minor, at fret 8 C minor. The same notes are also C major pentatonic.

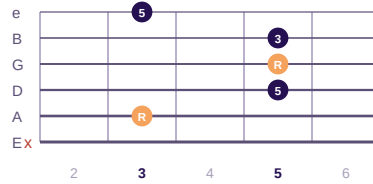
CHORDS

The CAGED map (C major)

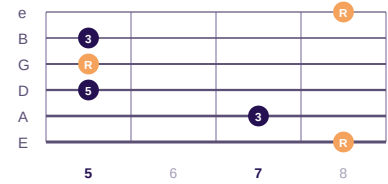
Every major chord can be played in five shapes named after the open chords C, A, G, E and D. Here is one C major chord, five ways, climbing the neck. R is the root, 3 the third, 5 the fifth.



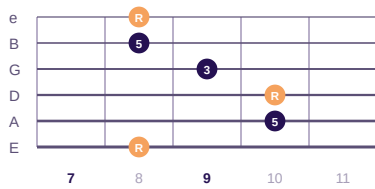
C shape



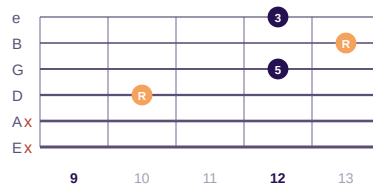
A shape



G shape



E shape



D shape

The order repeats: C, A, G, E, D, then C again twelve frets higher. Each shape shares its top notes with the next one's bottom notes, so the neck becomes one connected map.

A two-week memorization plan

Ten minutes a day beats two hours on a Sunday. Say every note out loud as you play it.

Days	Do this
1 to 2	Natural notes on the low E string, frets 0 to 12. Play them in order, then randomly as someone calls them.
3 to 4	Same on the A string. Then find each note on both strings.
5 to 6	Octave shapes from the E and A strings onto the D and G strings.
7	Rest, or a quiz: find every C on the neck in 30 seconds. Then every G.
8 to 9	Pentatonic shapes 1 and 2, naming each note as you play.
10 to 11	Shapes 3 to 5, then connect all five from the 3rd to the 17th fret.
12 to 13	CAGED shapes of C, then move them to G and D.
14	Improvise over a backing track and aim every phrase at a root or a chord tone.

Tracker

☐ Day 1☐ Day 2☐ Day 3☐ Day 4☐ Day 5☐ Day 6☐ Day 7☐ Day 8☐ Day 9☐ Day 10☐ Day 11☐ Day 12☐ Day 13☐ Day 14

Quiz yourself on the free Fretboard Explorer: guitarhub.org/fretboard.